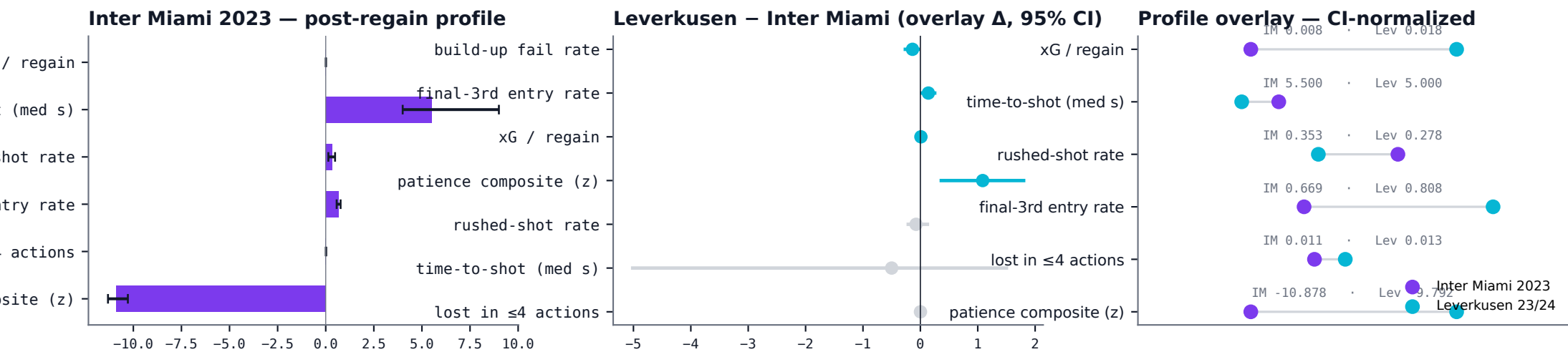


Pressured Progression

Two MLS failure modes — build-up collapse under pressure and post-regain waste — measured on Inter Miami 2023 (Messi's half-season, 6 matches) and benchmarked against Bayer Leverkusen 2023/24 (Alonso's unbeaten season, 34 matches) using StatsBomb Open Data and ASA.



Findings

- Build-up failure under pressure**
Inter Miami 34% [CI 25-45%]; Leverkusen 21% [CI 16-25%]; $\Delta = -14$ pp (CI excl. 0).
- Final-third entry after regain**
Leverkusen 81% [77-84%] vs Inter Miami 67% [57-77%]; $\Delta = +14$ pp (CI excl. 0).
- Post-regain waste**
90% of Inter Miami regains do not produce a shot within 15 s; a sizable regain-to-threat gap vs Leverkusen's attacking output.
- Model utility modest at small n**
CV ROC-AUC 0.54 ± 0.08 on 73 chains; LogReg baseline marginally better. Honest small-sample band.
- 4 of 7 cross-team deltas separable from noise**
at 95% CI; three (time-to-shot, rushed rate, ≤4-action loss) are not.

Methods

Sources
StatsBomb Open Data (events + 360); American Soccer Analysis v1.

Base years
MLS 2023 (6 Inter Miami matches); Bundesliga 2023/24 (34 Leverkusen matches).

Scope limit
Only Inter Miami appears in MLS 2023 Open Data; no league-wide event ranking.

Uncertainty
95% bootstrap CIs, matches resampled (not possessions).

Framing
Associational, not causal. No attribution to Alonso, Messi, Nancy, or any individual.